



Sniper: Ghost Warrior 2

A new DLC package for Sniper: Ghost Warrior 2 'Siberian Strike' was released on the PSN, Xbox Live and PC. <http://dgit.in/YkrHGp>

Portable Synthesizer

The OP-1 is an all-in-one portable synthesizer, sampler and controller from Teenage Engineering <http://dgit.in/WLKCXI>

VivoBook has the best black levels. It is fairly difficult to separate the two HP laptops, but the AMD version does have a price advantage without being at any sort of performance disadvantage over the Intel one. If you are, however, looking to consider something different, you should be looking at the VivoBook. It's small and light with a decent performance and an excellent 11.6-inch display that puts some of the bigger displays to shame.

Category 2:

₹40,000 - ₹49,999

This category has a steady mix of Core i3, Core i5 and even Core i7 processors. Which is why it's a surprise that the Inspiron 14 Turbo falls behind the HP Pavilion G62237tx (Intel Core i5-3210M) and the Acer Aspire V3-571G-53234G75Makk (Intel Core i5-3230M) in the PCMark 07 benchmark test. Where the Inspiron 14 Turbo fights back is in the graphics benchmarks. The Unigine FPS score is one such example, where the GT 640M scores the highest, with the AMD Radeon HD 7650M on the Sony VAIO E-series SVE15127CNB coming a close second.

The Sony Vaio E-series (SVE14A15FNB) – the only machine in this test still running the older Sandy Bridge processor – clocked 154 minutes in the battery test. If you look at the newer Ivy Bridge only laptops, then the HP Pavilion G6-2237tx has the lead with 127 minutes in our stressful test setup, while the rest stayed within a close range of each other.

Category 3:

₹50,000 - ₹59,999

Our old favourite, the Lenovo IdeaPad Z580 has seen a price correction since we tested it sometime last year. Though it's



Acer Aspire V3-571G-33114G75Makk

been around for some time now, it cannot be discounted. The HP G6 and the Z580 are neck and neck in terms of system performance in the PCMark test. The HP Envy m6 and the Toshiba L850 are fairly consistent in the benchmark scores, which is surprising considering the completely different processors powering both. Either this is good news for the m6, or bad news for the Toshiba!

The Z500, with the Nvidia GT645M graphics, took the

undisputed lead in terms of gaming performance. It scored 37 FPS in the Unigine test, with the elder sibling, the Z580 coming second with 35.8 FPS in the same test. The Toshiba L850, with the AMD Radeon HD7670 graphics did very well in the gaming tests.

In this category, the real competition is between the two Lenovo machines. We believe the Z500 makes a lot of sense, since it's a better performer than the Envy m6, which ide-

ally would have been its direct competitor considering the price. Do remember though, the Z580 and the Envy m6 offer better battery life.

Category 4:

₹60,000 - ₹70,000

In this category, it's clear that Sony is not bothering to compete with the rivals spec for spec on the sheet. The Sony VAIO T scores the highest in the PCMark 07 benchmark – more than the rivals with the Core i7 versions. One reason for that is the SSD; it's the only laptop in this test to feature that. While that indicates extremely good system performance, where the VAIO T loses out is in the gaming arena with just the Intel HD 4000 chip to rely on. Very good battery life though – tested life is 188 minutes.

The VAIO S will appeal to you because of its 15.5-inch full HD IPS LED display. This is one of the few machines sporting the 1080p display in this test – the Lenovo Y500 being the other one. The IPS LED spec makes this brilliant for multimedia and reading in equal quantities! It's literally unmatched in terms of colour richness. The Nvidia GT640M LE chip is the toned down version of the 640M we've seen in various other laptops, which explains why it's scoring lesser than the GT630M (HP Envy) and the GT650m (Lenovo Y500) in all graphics benchmark tests. Its tested battery life of 200 minutes is the highest in this category, and indeed among all laptops in this test.

The HP Envy dv6 scores consistently in all benchmarks, throughout. The performance of the system and graphics is right up there with the best scores in this category. And this consistency helped the dv6 get the highest performance points.



HP Pavilion G6-2301ax